ENGLISH LAB · READING CORNER

Maya Live!

A mystery at the skate park



Plus · A2+

2 ESO · Free Time, Live! · LS2
Six chapters · one a week

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How to read this book

Read one chapter a week at home, with the Learning Path it goes with. Read it once for the story, then again more slowly.

The words in the box at the start help you. They are underlined in the story.

At the end of each chapter, circle one answer to each question. In class we talk about the chapter for ten minutes and see who guessed what happens next.

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CHAPTER 1

Look behind you

Read it with Learning Path 1

WORDS TO HELP YOU

magician = *mag*
directly = *directament*
box = *capsa*
ground = *terra*
waiting = *esperant*

It's Saturday morning, but Maya's phone makes a loud noise at eight o'clock. Maya switches it off and gets up. Her little brother Teo is already playing video games in the living room. "You get up early for school and early for skating," he says. "That's not a weekend."

"And you spend all morning in front of a screen," Maya replies. "That's not a sport."

Maya is thirteen, and skating is her favourite activity.

She practises every weekend at the skate park. She has got a small video channel called Maya Live! with 46 subscribers. Her best friend Sami takes photos and records videos. He doesn't skate, but he is good at getting the best picture. At the park, Maya puts on her tracksuit and helmet. The weather is windy, and the trees are moving. "Today I'm trying a new move," she says.

"Great. I'm recording everything," Sami says. "Not everything. Please take out the part with my face on the ground."

"I'm a photographer, not a magician." They laugh.

Maya starts skating and Sami points the camera at her. "Hi, everyone! Welcome to my vlog! Today I'm at the skate park. It's cold and windy, but I'm having a great time. This is Sami, my friend who always loses his cap!"

The wind takes Sami's cap, and he runs after it. On Sunday evening Maya finishes her homework.

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She is spending time on her channel when a new comment appears. It's from Fox_13, a subscriber she doesn't know. "Great video! But look behind you at 2:14."

Maya checks the video. At 2:14, behind her, there's a person under a tree. The person is wearing a black helmet and an orange cap. At the moment the person is putting a small green box on the ground. Then the person looks directly at the camera. The person isn't smiling or waving.

A second later, the person runs away.

"Teo, is this your idea of a joke?" Maya asks. "No! My jokes are better than that." Maya sends Sami a message with the time of the video. He replies straight away: "That helmet isn't yours. I don't know that person."

"Do you believe it's a game?" she types.

"Maybe. But we need to check. And I want to know what's inside that box."

Maya watches the five seconds again.

She doesn't know Fox_13, but Fox_13 clearly knows her channel. And, somewhere in the park, a green box is waiting.

THINK ABOUT IT

Circle one answer for each question.

1 · DID YOU UNDERSTAND?

What does Maya see behind her in the video?

- (A) A person putting a box under a tree
- (B) A dog riding a bike
- (C) Teo playing football

2 · WHAT HAPPENS NEXT? GUESS!

What is inside the green box?

- (A) A mobile phone
- (B) An orange T-shirt and a card
- (C) A bicycle helmet

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CHAPTER 2

The box

Read it with Learning Path 2

WORDS TO HELP YOU

complaint = *queixa*
impossible = *impossible*
umbrella = *paraigua*
scarf = *bufanda*
bench = *banc*

On Monday after school, Maya and Sami return to the skate park. It's raining, and Sami has got an very big umbrella. Both friends can stand under it.

"We're looking for a green box," Maya says. "Not an box in the water."

"Then why is the weather so terrible?" Sami asks. They find the box under the big tree next to the bench. The outside is wet, but inside there is a dry orange T-shirt and a card. Maya reads it for Sami: "BROOKFIELD AUTUMN FUN RUN. Sunday, 10:00, at the park. Wear this T-shirt. Look for the fox."

"I don't believe this," Maya says. "I love skating. I hate running."

"You like a good mystery more than you hate running. It's true."

Maya puts the T-shirt in her bag. She usually thinks about skating moves or music in class. This week she's thinking about the green box. Every evening she checks her channel. Fox_13 stays quiet.

"Is this a new kind of fan?" Teo asks at dinner.

"I don't know."

"Then don't give your phone to a strange person," Teo says.

"And don't give them my games." On Saturday, Maya asks Sami to go running with her. They run for twenty minutes. Sami is fine, but Maya is sitting on a bench and drinking water. "I can skate for an hour," she says. "My legs are making a complaint."

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“We’re making progress,” Sami answers. “Very slow progress, but progress.”

On Sunday the weather is foggy and freezing.

Maya puts the orange shirt over her tracksuit. Sami wears a scarf, a hat and trainers. At the park a crowd is cheering. There is music, a small food fair and a table with water. The runners are warming up.

“Where is our mystery person?” Maya asks.

Sami points at a runner. “Orange T-shirt.”

Maya points at another. “Orange T-shirt.”

Then they notice the big problem. Everybody is wearing the same orange shirt.

The runners, the helpers, the children and even a dog are wearing orange. It’s almost impossible to find one person.

“Fox_13 is good at this,” Sami says. “We’re taking part in a big game, and we don’t know the rules.”

Maya is looking for an orange cap and a black helmet, but there are too many people. She doesn’t want to give up. She enjoys games that make her think, even when the weather is terrible. Then a voice behind her says, “Hi, Maya. Nice T-shirt.” Maya turns around slowly. Sami stops smiling. Someone knows her name.

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THINK ABOUT IT

Circle one answer for each question.

1 · DID YOU UNDERSTAND?

What does the card ask Maya to do?

- (A) Go to the Fun Run in an orange T-shirt
- (B) Buy a new skateboard
- (C) Take Teo to school

2 · WHAT HAPPENS NEXT? GUESS!

Who says “Nice T-shirt” at the race?

- (A) Leo Fox
- (B) Maya’s mum
- (C) Kate, the organiser

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CHAPTER 3

Not today

Read it with Learning Path 3

WORDS TO HELP YOU

clipboard = *carpeta amb pinça*
detective = *detectiu*
finish line = *línia d'arribada*
disappear = *desaparèixer*
helpers = *ajudants*

Maya turns around quickly. She's ready for the person in the black helmet, but there is only a tall woman with a clipboard. She is wearing an orange shirt with a small fox. "Hello, Maya. I'm Kate. I organise the Fun Run. Can you help us?"

"How do you know who I am?" Maya asks.

Kate smiles and points at the little name card on Maya's T-shirt. "It's right here."

Sami starts laughing. "Excellent mystery work, detective Maya."

"Thanks, Sami. Very nice."

Kate takes them to the water table. "The runners are coming soon. We need people who can give them water."

"Does this mean we don't need to run?" Maya asks.

"Exactly."

"I love being a helper already."

Maya and Sami work together. They're giving cups of water to the runners. A man in a banana costume takes a cup, and a small girl asks for two cups. One is for her dog.

"Your dog is taking part in the race?" Sami asks.

"Yes, and he's faster than my dad!" she says.

Sami takes a photo of the banana and another of the dog. He usually prefers taking pictures of people skating, but today the crowd is full of interesting costumes. Maya starts recording a vlog. "Hi, everyone, welcome

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back to Maya Live! I usually go skating on Sundays, but today I'm at the Brookfield Fun Run. People are running, the crowd is cheering, and we're giving out water. We aren't taking part in the race. We're helping the runners!"

She notices how much fun people are having. She doesn't like running, but she does like this festival. It's a good break from her screen, even when she's using her camera. Then Sami stops taking photos. He is looking at something near the finish line. "Maya. That bike. Look at the helmet."

She turns. A person in a black helmet and orange cap is standing next to a bike. The person is recording the runners. "I know that helmet! It's Fox_13!"

They run towards the finish line, but it's foggy and there are hundreds of people. The person and the bike disappear in the crowd. Maya stops and looks everywhere.

"We can't find anybody here," Sami says. "Maybe that is the plan."

Then Maya sees something on the ground. It's a small card: "Good job, helpers! Next clue: check my channel."

"So Fox_13 has got a video channel too," Sami says.

"Yes, but there can be many people with that name," Maya replies. "We need to check the author and the date. A good source is important, even for a mystery."

Sami puts his camera away. "Then tonight we become internet detectives."

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THINK ABOUT IT

Circle one answer for each question.

1 · DID YOU UNDERSTAND?

What are Maya and Sami doing at the Fun Run?

A Selling trainers

B Giving water to runners

C Playing video games

2 · WHAT HAPPENS NEXT? GUESS!

What important clue do they find on Fox_13's channel?

A A blue bag with the BHS school logo

B A letter from Australia

C A photo of Maya's mum

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CHAPTER 4

Can you trust it?

Read it with Learning Path 4

WORDS TO HELP YOU

reliable source = *font fiable*
logo = *logotip*
probably = *probablement*
credits = *crèdits*
careful = *prudent*

On Sunday evening Maya and Sami are at the kitchen table. Teo is sitting next to them with an apple. Maya has got her laptop, and the three of them are trying to find Fox_13.

"Type the name," Sami says.

"That's only the first step," Maya replies. "We need a reliable source. Who is the author, what is the date, and can we trust the information?"

Sami puts up his hands. "Fine. Internet detective school is now open."

The first result is a page about real foxes. It has lots of colourful photos, but there's no author, no date and no clear source. Teo likes the pictures. "That's a very nice animal," he says.

"It's not the person on the bike," Maya says. "And we don't know who writes this page."

The second result is a gaming channel. It has got the right name, but the owner lives in Australia and doesn't upload videos now. Its latest video is from 2019.

"Maybe the fox flies to Brookfield every weekend," Sami says. "Very funny. Check the date again."

Then they find a tiny channel called Fox_13: Brookfield Bikes. It has got three subscribers and five videos. Today's video shows the Fun Run, the finish line and a person in a black helmet. The orange cap is easy to see.

"That's our person!" Sami says. They watch the older videos. The rider is cycling around Brookfield and practising at the bike park. No video shows

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a face.

At the end of each one there are credits for the music and photos.

“Good,” Maya says. “This person understands why it’s important to credit a source.”

“But they don’t want to show us their face,” Sami adds.

Teo is getting bored. He wants to play online. Just as he starts to leave, a blue school bag appears at the end of the video. “Stop! Look!” he says.

The bag has got a green tree and the letters BHS.

Maya and Sami know the logo. They see it every day at school.

“Brookfield High School,” Maya says. “It’s our school.”

“So the person is probably a student there,” Sami says. “Someone is watching your skating videos and making clues for you.”

“That isn’t always bad,” Maya says, “but we don’t know this person. We need to be careful.”

At that exact moment, a new video appears on the channel. They press play. It’s only a black screen with white words: “TOMORROW. ROOM 13. BREAK TIME.” Nobody speaks for a few seconds.

“Room 13 is at our school,” Sami says.

“I know,” Maya replies. “And this time, Fox_13 is choosing the meeting place.”

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THINK ABOUT IT

Circle one answer for each question.

1 · DID YOU UNDERSTAND?

Why is the Brookfield Bikes channel the right one?

A It has millions of subscribers

B It shows today's Fun Run and the black helmet

C It is a channel about wild animals

2 · WHAT HAPPENS NEXT? GUESS!

Who is Fox_13?

A Kate

B Teo

C Leo, the new student

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CHAPTER 5

Room 13

Read it with Learning Path 5

WORDS TO HELP YOU

strangers = *desconeguts*
uncomfortable = *incòmode*
puzzles = *trencaclosques*
credits = *crèdits*
opposite = *davant de*

It's midnight, and Maya is still awake. She's watching Fox_13's videos for the fourth time. She's trying to find a clue about Room 13, but every video shows the same bike and the same black helmet. Her mum opens the bedroom door. "Maya, it's twelve o'clock. Switch off your phone. Don't use it in bed."

"I'm not playing games. I'm doing research."

"Then do your research tomorrow. Put your phone away."

The next morning Maya is tired and has no time for breakfast.

She usually pays attention in class, but today her mind is somewhere else. She's thinking about the school library, because Room 13 is the library. At break time Sami is waiting outside the door. "Ready to meet the mysterious fox?" he asks.

"Yes. No. Maybe."

"That's three answers. Choose one."

They walk inside together. The library is quiet. At a table in the corner there is one boy reading a comic. He's new at the school.

His name is Leo, and Maya sometimes sees him sitting alone at lunch. She doesn't know much about him. Next to his comic there is a black helmet and an orange cap. Maya stops.

"Well," Sami says quietly, "that's quite a big clue."

"Hi," Maya says to the boy. "Are you Fox_13?"

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Leo looks up, goes red and puts his comic down. “Yes. I’m Leo Fox. I love your channel.”

“Then why don’t you just leave a normal comment?” Maya asks.

Leo looks at the table. “I’m not good at meeting new people. I want to make friends, but talking to strangers is difficult. I love making puzzles and filming on my bike, so I make a game instead.”

Sami sits opposite him. “An interesting choice. But now you’ve got two new friends in front of you.”

“I’m sorry about the surprise,” Leo says. “I don’t want to make you uncomfortable.”

“I don’t mind a good mystery,” Maya replies.

“But next time, please ask before you make a game about us.” Leo agrees. He explains that Kate is his aunt and helps at the Fun Run. She knows about the orange T-shirt, but she doesn’t know all the clues.

“Your video credits are good,” Sami says. “And you’re good at recording bikes.”

“Do you like skating?” Maya asks.

“I prefer cycling, but I want to try filming your next vlog.”

Maya smiles. “That’s a much better way to make friends.”

Leo opens his school bag, takes out a small green box and places it between them. “I have one last clue,” he says. “This one isn’t a secret.”

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THINK ABOUT IT

Circle one answer for each question.

1 · DID YOU UNDERSTAND?

Why does Leo create the mystery game?

- (A) He wants to make friends but feels shy
- (B) He wants to win a race
- (C) He wants to take Maya's phone

2 · WHAT HAPPENS NEXT? GUESS!

What is the final green-box clue for?

- (A) A football match
- (B) Making a vlog together
- (C) Another running race

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CHAPTER 6

Maya Live! with friends

Read it with Learning Path 6

WORDS TO HELP YOU

proper = *de debò*
advice = *consell*
ramps = *rampes*
surprised = *sorprès*
owl = *mussol*

Leo opens his final green box. Maya is waiting for another difficult puzzle, but there's only a simple card: "Saturday, 11:00. Bike park. Bring your camera."

"What do we need to find this time?" Sami asks.

"Nothing," Leo says. "I just want to make a proper video with you. Can I join Maya Live! for one day?"

"Of course," Maya replies. "But no more mystery boxes without asking us first."

"OK," Leo says.

On Saturday the weather is sunny and cold.

It's a good day for being outside. Maya is wearing her tracksuit and helmet. Sami has got his camera, and Leo is waiting beside his bike. Maya likes making a plan before recording. Leo takes out a notebook, and together they decide on the parts: a greeting, some skating, some cycling, photos, their favourite activities, a short screen tip and a goodbye.

"We need a funny moment too," Sami says.

"You can fall off a skateboard," Maya suggests.

"I'm not going anywhere near one," he answers. "I'm good at taking photos, not breaking my legs."

They start recording. Maya looks at the camera and smiles. "Hi, everyone, and welcome to Maya Live! Today I'm at the bike park with my best

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friend Sami and our new friend Leo Fox. You know him as Fox_13, but today he's using his real name."

Leo is a bit shy at first. He waves and almost forgets what to say.

Maya waits, and nobody laughs at him. "Hi," he says at last. "I love cycling and making videos. I'm not very good at speaking to a camera, but I'm practising!"

Maya smiles. "That's perfect. No need to be someone else."

Then they film the action. Leo is riding his bike, Maya is skating on the ramps, and Sami is taking photos. Maya usually skates at another park, so the new ramps are difficult. She makes a mistake, smiles and tries again.

They finish with their screen advice.

"We spend a lot of time online," Maya says. "Videos are fun, but we need other things too."

"Take a break," Leo adds. "Put your phone away, go outside and meet people in real life. You don't need a mystery game to make a friend."

"But it makes an interesting video," Sami says.

Everybody laughs. On Sunday evening Maya uploads the video. She checks the comments and sees lots of kind messages. The channel now has 120 subscribers.

Leo is happy, and Sami is already choosing photos for another video. Then Maya's phone makes a sound. There's a new comment from someone called Owl_7.

"Great video! But look behind you at 3:05…" Maya reads the comment twice. "Sami, are you making another puzzle?"

"Not me," he says.

Leo looks surprised too. A new mystery is starting, and this time nobody knows who is behind it.

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THINK ABOUT IT

Circle one answer for each question.

1 · DID YOU UNDERSTAND?

What screen tip does Leo give?

- (A) Watch videos all night
- (B) Buy a bigger phone
- (C) Put your phone away and go outside

2 · WHAT HAPPENS NEXT? GUESS!

What will Maya most likely check first in the next story?

- (A) The video at 3:05
- (B) A new pair of trainers
- (C) Her Maths homework

✦ ✦ ✦

To be continued...

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